

West Bengal State Electricity Distribution Company Limited
(A Government of West Bengal Enterprise)

CIRCULAR NO: 14/2010 Dated: 18.06.2010
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**Sub: Revised guidelines for hiring accommodation
for Group Electric Supply offices/other offices**

It is reported that it is difficult to get rented houses for accommodation of different offices including Group Electric Supply offices identified for modernization because the conditions set out in the existing circular are very stringent and house owners are reluctant to let out their houses where prospect of having reasonable rent over a period of time remains uncertain. In many cases it hampers the activities of the company to a serious extent. Accordingly, the guidelines issued earlier vide Office Order No.87/190 dated 19.11.1987 are modified to the following extent:-

- 1) Depending upon the location of a Group Electric Supply office in urban, semi-urban and rural area and its consumer strength, required floor space should generally vary between 2500 to 3000 sq.ft. comprised in one or two floors.
- 2) Whenever it is necessary to hire a new accommodation, a contractual agreement may be signed with the house-owner for three years at the prevailing market rate considered to be reasonable and the agreement may be got registered. Such contracts may be renewed at an interval of three years with fresh terms and conditions including revised rent as per current market rate. However, if the house owner agrees to hike of rent @ 15% after every three years and it remains unchanged for next three years, such agreement can be signed for a longer period not exceeding 9 (nine) years at a stretch. In all such agreements necessary provision shall be kept so that certain internal changes of the building to suit the business requirements can be carried out legally without impacting the basic structure of the building.
- 3) For ascertaining the reasonableness of market rate of rent, any of the following documents/certificates may be considered reliable for determining the rent at current market rate:
 - a) Rents at which accommodations taken by banks/insurance companies/other government and semi-government offices in the locality or fair rent certificate from the land acquisition collector. Whenever any such document is not available in respect of the area where the office is to be located, such certificates for areas with same/similar demographic features may also be taken as a valid document.

- b) While identifying the location of the building, convenience of the customers, easy movement of traffic/vehicles, separate toilets for ladies and gents, proper water supply system, safety and security of the building should merit consideration.
- 4) Whenever such accommodation is required for quite a good number of such offices, proposals from house-owners may be obtained through notification in the daily news papers/local news papers centrally by the Circle office or by the Corporate HQ. In other cases, such accommodation can be secured through local investigation by the respective Head of the unit.
- 5) Officers are hereby vested with the financial power to accord approval to the proposal for monthly rent as per the following scale :-

<u>Monthly Rent</u>	<u>Approving Authority</u>
A. Upto Rs.10,000/-	Divisional Manager
B. Rs.10,001 – Rs.15,000/-	Circle manager / Project Manager
C. Rs.15,001 – Rs.25,000/-	Zonal Manager
D. Rs.25,001 – Rs.50,000/-	Chief Engineer (Distribution/respective Dept.)
E. Beyond Rs.50,000/-	Director (HR)

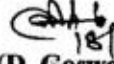
6) Divisional Managers are hereby advised to identify the houses for Group Electric Supplies for the purpose of modernization with priority and complete the exercise within six months.

7) The same principles shall be followed in respect of offices other than Group Electric Supplies. In case of Project related activities, such financial powers shall be exercised by the Project Manager or the Chief Engineer, as the case may be.

8) In such cases where existing accommodation is insufficient or there are certain problems/disputes with the landlord/unsurmountable exogenous problems, concerned unit head can take steps to search alternative location with the approval of his controlling officer.

9) For any complicated issue, the matter may be referred to the Corporate Headquarter.

This issues with the approval of Chairman & Managing Director and shall take immediate effect.


18/6/10
(D. Goswami)
Director (HR)